ADRIAN CIOANCA

PhD | Data & AI Consultant | Biotech Co-founder | **NV1 Security Clearance**

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PROFILE

Applying for the Senior Consultant – Data Engineer role. A track record of taking ambiguous technical problems through to delivered, client-facing outcomes: leading data engineering teams and client delivery at Accenture, and before that running large-scale statistical inference as a postdoctoral researcher. That combination, rigour built in research and judgement built in front of clients, is the headline this role is screening for.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Accenture | Strategy & Consulting, Data & AI | Consultant / Team Lead — Jan 2026 – Present

- Led a 3-person data engineering team to diagnose a national energy retailer's regulatory compliance bottleneck, then designed a data pipeline (PostgreSQL storage, text embedding, hybrid vector + BM25 retrieval) surfacing relevant changes at **>99%** accuracy; worked directly with the client's compliance team to translate the requirement, cutting clause identification time from days to minutes.
- Architected and built an internal Defence market-intelligence platform (React, FastAPI, PostgreSQL/pgvector, migrating to Azure Blob/GCP Cloud Storage) integrating AusTender, ministerial releases and competitor activity into dashboards and AI-generated reports; reduced opportunity research from hours to minutes and now feeds market sizing for live bids.
- Took ownership of a proof-of-concept data pipeline for a Defence client in a secure, air-gapped cloud environment, designing the architecture, analytical steps and tool integration end to end; demonstrated that the team could deliver production-grade data products under air-gapped constraints.

ErythroSIGHT | Co-founder & CTO — 2023 – Present

- Co-founded an ANU spin-off commercialising blood-derived retinal therapeutics; built the valuation and market case using discounted-cash-flow and risk-adjusted NPV models, prevalence and pricing, co-developing investor materials and pitching at 3 national accelerators, raising **$670K** in non-dilutive funding and winning CSIRO ON Accelerate (<5% acceptance).
- Set the scientific strategy for ErythroSIGHT's lead therapeutic: selected the candidate, built the R&D pipeline through pre-clinical and toxicology testing, and generated the resulting intellectual property, securing **3** national patents.

Australian National University | Postdoctoral Researcher, John Curtin School of Medical Research — 2022 – 2026

- Worked as an embedded technical consultant for industry partners, securing a **$300K** engagement with Beta Therapeutics and delivering a **$200K** end-to-end preclinical model for Merck & Co.; cut time to results from 3 months to 2 weeks and returned **8x** the build cost, with Merck moving the work in-house on completion.
- Led a 7-person team across 20 research groups at 7 universities developing RNA therapeutics for retinal degeneration; reached 25 papers (9 lead-author), ranked 3rd nationally in the field, and secured **$514K** in competitive funding.
- Earned promotion to Level B in 1.5 years versus a typical 4–5 year progression, demonstrating sustained performance in research leadership and delivery.

EDUCATION

Australian National University | PhD, Neuroscience & Bioinformatics — 2018 – 2022

- **Frank Fenner Medal** for best PhD at the John Curtin School of Medical Research (1 of 103); J.G. Crawford Prize nominee for best thesis at ANU.
- Australian Postgraduate Award ($112K, top 5%); 4 competitive research grants ($97K; 5–10% success rates); elected ANU representative to the Global Young Scientists Summit.

University of New South Wales | BSc Advanced Science, First Class Honours — 2013 – 2017

- Top honours thesis mark; 2 research scholarships awarded to the top 10% of the faculty.

LEADERSHIP & ADDITIONAL

- **Teaching & leadership:** Sole genetics lecturer, ANU Medical School (4.8/5 average across 87 evaluations); founded Vision ACTion, connecting clinicians, researchers and patients.
- Led 5-person team to 2nd of 10 at InnovFest Singapore, pitching to Westpac and Singtel; recognised for delivery/community contribution by 3 Accenture Managing Directors.
- Developed pitch decks and solution materials for senior managers supporting Accenture contract bids; built an internal AI agent helping early-career recruits find their best-fit service line.

CAPABILITIES

Data & Cloud: Python, SQL, R, PostgreSQL, AlloyDB, pgvector, Hadoop, Dataproc, Elastic, Azure (incl. DevOps), AWS, GCP, ETL/data-pipeline design, BI (Power BI, Tableau) | **Delivery:** Solution architecture, stakeholder translation, team leadership & mentoring, client advisory, proposal development